

YOU GOT THIS, LIAM HAYMORE!

Written by

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INT. LIAM'S BEDROOM - MORNING

In a messy bedroom, CLOSE ON an alarm clock. 6:59 turns to 7:00 -- **BEEP BEEP BEEP!**

SUPER TITLE: "I. GOOD MORNING, LIAM HAYMORE"

A *RHYTHMIC PULSE* begins as:

A hand SLAMS on the alarm clock. He misses it, but manages to shut it off by knocking it to the ground.

Push in on a shaggy-haired college senior. This is LIAM HAYMORE. He yawns and looks at his phone.

INSERT: **Three REMINDERS: "Cram study for test," "dodgeball," and "anniversary dinner"**

He clicks on the dinner reminder, then navigates to YELP to check out the prices.

INSERT: \$\$\$

He sighs and gets up.

INT. LIAM'S HOUSE

BEGIN MONTAGE

Liam steps into the shower, YELPS, and jumps back out from a cloud of steam.

At the bathroom sink, he lathers his face... then nicks himself with the razor -- a small bead of blood forms.

Liam puts on his favorite t-shirt. He looks down: it has a stain. He switches into something else.

Distracted by his phone in the kitchen, a text message lights up the screen.

SADIE

(text)

Good luck on ur test i cant wait
for tn, last year feels like a
lifetime ago <3

Liam smiles for the first time all morning.

INSERT: **"a lifetime ago <3"**

Liam scrunches his face, re-reading the text.

LIAM
(under breath)
A lifetime?

The smell of smoke hits him. His eggs have burned.

He groans. His laptop on the counter PINGS with an email:

INSERT: **EMAIL SUBJECT: Midterm Grade Reminder**

EMAIL BODY: Mr. Haymore, a reminder that a minimum C+ average is required to maintain your Academic Scholarship.

He puts his head in his hands. The pressure's mounting.

He gives up and pours a bowl of cereal. He grabs the milk from the fridge and gags as a chunky, sour liquid plops out.

For his only moment of solace, he feeds his pet betta fish in his bedroom, FINN.

LIAM
(gently)
You got this, Finn.

He takes a deep breath and packs his backpack.

As he exits the house, he sees a JERSEY on the floor.

LIAM
Damn it, Jacob.

His INHALER slips silently from his backpack's side pocket, falling on the floor, unseen by Liam.

A **BZZ BZZ BZZ** alerts him: "LEAVE NOW FOR TEST."

He hustles out and lands right into a mud puddle. He groans, then turns around to change his shoes.

As he returns through his door, we:

END MONTAGE

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. LECTURE HALL - DAY

Liam, donning new, dumb shoes, loudly opens the door to a large, drab lecture hall. He's a panting mess.

He looks at the ocean of students hunched over their MIDTERM EXAMS. The only sounds are the frantic scratching of pencils and the occasional nervous cough.

CLOSE ON a large, institutional clock. The second hand moves with a loud, punishing **TICK... TICK... TICK...**

We track him as he passes his peers, walking to a desk.

LIAM
(through rushed breaths)
Sorry... sorry... alarm...

SUPER TITLE: "II. YOU GOT THIS, LIAM HAYMORE"

He grabs a test from a stack and scurries to the only empty seat. His pencils clatter loudly as he dumps his bag out, getting a death stare from the PROFESSOR at the front.

Liam finally settles, his pounding heart decelerating as he takes a deep breath and looks at the first question.

A wave of confusion rushes over his face. It's a foreign language. He wipes his sweaty palms on his jeans.

Back to the **ticking** of the clock. Five minutes pass.

Liam's page is still empty, except for his name. Everybody else is writing furiously. His heart begins pounding.

Liam nervously checks his Apple Watch.

PROFESSOR (O.S.)
(sternly)
Is that your phone, Liam?

Liam flinches. The professor is staring him down from the front of the room.

LIAM
Oh, it's just my watch, I was
checking the -

PROFESSOR
(forceful, but quiet)
Put. It. Away.

Liam, humiliated, rolls his eyes and mutters something.

LIAM
(mocking)
Put it away.

PROFESSOR
What was that?

His head snaps up. The professor's still staring him down.

LIAM
(panicked)
Nothing! Sorry. Sorry.

He focuses back on the impossible test. The sounds of the room begin to close in on him:

The steady **TICK** of the clock.

The nervous, rhythmic **TAP-TAP-TAP** of a pencil against a desk.

The frantic **SCRATCH-SCRATCH** of erasers.

Liam's eyes squeeze shut. He takes a single, sharp breath.

A harsh spotlight hits his face. The drab fluorescent light of the hall becomes **WARM**.

The sounds start to layer, faster and faster, no longer random but locking into a distinct, maddening beat. The crescendo builds until it merges seamlessly into the opening instrumental of "**I GOT THIS**."

Suddenly, as if MK Ultra'd, the students of the class begin this choreographed routine. Liam initially looks around with a "what the fuck?" face, but a big grin slowly emerges .

The students begin approaching Liam as the instrumental builds into:

LIAM
TBD LYRICS: OVERWHELMING PANIC AND SELF-DOUBT

CLOSE UP on the words on the test, a confusing jumble of overspecific jargon. In pencil: "I don't know!"

The music swells into the chorus.

STUDENTS
(singing)
You got this!

His confidence builds, and he moves from his chair to the desk, rising above the circling students.

LIAM
(singing)
TBD LYRICS: POWERFUL CHORUS ABOUT REALIZING
THAT "I GOT THIS!"

On the downbeat, all the students SLAM their hands on his desk in a single, percussive THUD.

The students now form two straight lines, creating an aisle leading to the PROFESSOR'S desk.

LIAM

TBD LYRICS: FINDING CLARITY AND FOCUS

Liam dances down the aisle with swagger. He grabs a clipboard and writes as he skips.

The other students use their pencils to drum on their desks.

The music builds to its climax for the final chorus. The students at the front link their hands, creating a staircase.

LIAM

TBD LYRICS: FINAL TRIUMPHANT CHORUS

"I GOT THIS!"

Liam falls back onto the crowd.

The students crowd-surf him over their heads toward the front of the room as he holds his test in the air like a trophy.

They gently set him on his feet before the Professor's desk as the song hits its final chord.

SMASH CUT TO:

Liam slaps his completed test down on the desk with a loud THWACK. The hall is back to its drab, fluorescent self.

The students are back to work.

PROFESSOR

(anticlimactic)

My TAs will work on this today. We might have grades by tonight.

LIAM

Oh, right. Thanks, professor!

PROFESSOR

Mhm.

Liam walks through the aisle, wearing a proud smile on his face. A **BUZZ** from his pocket. He checks his phone: "**3:00 DODGEBALL.**" He hustles out the doors.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. GYMNASIUM - DAY

Liam enters a large gymnasium. Four guys wearing blue pinnies are stretching: JACOB, JORDAN, JEREMY, and JESSE.

Liam jogs over, a bit out of breath.

SUPER TITLE: "III. FEEL THE RHYTHM, JLIAM HAYMORE"

JACOB

Has anybody seen my -

Hunched over, Liam hands over the JERSEY he got earlier.

JACOB

Oh shit! Thanks, Liam. Where were you, anyway? Game's about to start.

LIAM

(catching breath)
One second.

JORDAN

The finals begin in fifteen minutes! We've gotta warm up.

LIAM

(taken aback)
Finals? I thought this was just an intramural thing. Like, for fun.

JEREMY

No, man. You're filling in for our fifth. He tore his ACL.

JESSE

I texted you this! Like, five times.

Liam pulls out his phone and quickly scrolls through the unread messages.

JESSE (TEXT)

FINALS TODAY! \$500 PRIZE FOR WINNING!!

JESSE (TEXT)

WE GOTTA WIN YOU THAT DINNER MONEY

JESSE (TEXT)

WHERE ARE YOU?!

LIAM

Shit. Sorry.

He quickly scrolls back up.

INSERT: **\$500 PRIZE FOR WINNING!!**

LIAM

Wait, we get money for this?

Jesse throws his hands up.

JESSE

(exasperated)

That's what I was texting you about!

JACOB

Whatever, you're here now. Let's take these jerseys off. We gotta look badass.

The four guys pull off their pinnies in unison. Underneath, they're all wearing matching, custom t-shirts. On the front:

THE J-CREW

Their names are on the back of each shirt: **JACOB, JEREMY, JESSE, JORDAN.**

JORDAN

(to Liam)

C'mon, suit up.

Jeremy digs into a gym bag and pulls a fifth, identical shirt. He tosses it to Liam. The name on the back is JUSTIN.

LIAM

Who the hell is Justin?

JEREMY

My roommate. Don't worry, I got this.

Jeremy pulls a thick, black SHARPIE from his bag. He grabs the shirt and, with a surgeon's focus, begins scribbling.

He holds it up to the crew, who approve. The shirt now reads:

JLIAM

JESSE

Perfect. Now you're official.

Liam stares at the ridiculous sharpie job on the shirt.

LIAM
(resigned)
Jliam.

JACOB
Just take the shirt.

Liam takes the shirt from Jeremy and puts it on. A loud WHISTLE blows from across the gym.

INT. DODGEBALL COURT - DAY

The J-Crew stands opposite THE ANNIHILATORS, five big, intimidating dudes in matching red pinnies. Liam looks like he's about to have a panic attack.

The REFEREE stands at the center line, with a row of red rubber balls between the teams. Liam breathes heavily.

REFEREE
Three... two... one...

The Referee blows a piercing WHISTLE -- game time.

BEGIN MONTAGE

Both teams SPRINT to the center line. The Annihilators move like wolves, scooping up every ball. The J-Crew gets none.

Jordan trips over his own feet, scrambling back. As he crawls backwards, a ball narrowly MISSES him. Another MISS. One more. He makes it to the back of the line, taking a breath. He gets PELTED in the stomach. **4-5.**

REFEREE (O.S.)
Out!

Jesse and Liam grab two of the balls, rocketing toward one of the Annihilators, knocking him out. **4-4.**

A ball rockets toward Jesse. He raises his hands to catch it, but it's thrown too hard. The ball deflects off his fingers and into the wall. **3-4.**

REFEREE (O.S.)
Out!

Jeremy blocks one of the balls with his own, returning fire... right into the hands of an Annihilator. **2-5.**

REFEREE
Out! Annihilators, bring someone in.

Liam throws a few balls. One of the Annihilators terrifyingly smiles as he blocks each of them. Liam makes eye contact but fakes him out with a shot to the left, smacking one of them in the face. Ouch. **2-4.**

Jacob winds up and hurls his ball—it's a perfect, high arc... right into the hands of an Annihilator. **1-5.**

REFEREE (O.S.)
You're out! Annihilators, you can
bring another back.

END MONTAGE

The Annihilator Liam just eliminated walks back on and looks **PISSED**. Liam stands alone, heaving for breath.

Holding every ball, the opponents come together in a semi-circle like a wolf pack cornering their prey.

The heavy breathing Liam's been fighting intensifies into a ragged, audible **WHEEZING**.

CLOSE ON Liam's face. Pure terror. The echo of the gym seems to fade away, replaced by the sound of his frantic heartbeat and breathing. His eyes dart between opponents.

He instinctively slaps his empty pocket. The horrifying realization hits him again: **he doesn't have his inhaler.**

Everything is closing in on him. The bright fluorescents of the gym seem to pulse and blur.

He doubles over, gasping for air as he clutches his chest.

He squeezes his eyes shut, taking a deep, shaky breath.

And the world goes **completely silent.**

The ambience of the gym, footsteps, and heartbeat... **gone.**

For a single, terrifying beat.

Then...

A single, sharp **SNAP** echoes from his hands.

The opening beat of **"RHYTHM OF THE RICOCHET"** kicks in. Liam's eyes snap open. His breathing evens out, locking into the tempo of the music.

The world suddenly becomes technicolor and vibrant. The sidelines now feature a group of cheerleaders.

The defeated J-Crew members get to their feet and walk to the sidelines, snapping in unison. They're like the Jets in *West Side Story*.

The Annihilators look at each other, then prepare to throw. Liam continues to snap.

A ball comes HURTLING at Liam. With wicked precision, his hand flies up and CATCHES the ball mid-air.

With a sharp, confident gesture, he points to JACOB, beckoning him back into the game.

Liam and Jacob, connected through song, navigate a torrent of balls. Liam catches another one. Jacob uses his ball to deflect another.

They turn and point to the sideline, Jeremy CARTWHEELS back onto the court, rejoining the gang.

The music grows more aggressive. Liam, Jacob, and Jeremy move into a triangular formation. An Annihilator throws his ball nervously.

On a beat, they THROW at once.

SMACK! That Annihilator is eliminated. They catch his ball, signaling for Jesse to come back in.

The Annihilators throw an onslaught of balls -- the four J-Crew scatter, deflecting every ball thrown their way.

Jesse catches one, bringing Jordan back in.

In a line formation, a final volley comes from the Annihilators. Each ball is **BLOCKED**.

The J-Crew look at each other with a reassuring nod. In a synchronized motion, they prepare to throw and launch their balls one by one -- each one **HITS**.

The Annihilators lay in a pile with those birds you'd see in a cartoon circling their heads. The ref, blows his whistle.

REFEREE
(bewildered)
Uh, the J-Crew wins.

They break into a genuine, chaotic celebration. They hoist Liam up onto their shoulders.

On his smile, we:

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. LIAM'S CAR - LATER

Liam drives, the windows down, like the king of the world he is. He's drumming a fast, complex beat on his steering wheel: the theme from **"Rhythm of the Ricochet."**

A phone BUZZ.

INSERT: **A text: "BoFA: Jacob Thigpen sent you \$100.00 for 'BIG MAN!'"**

He pumps his fist.

LIAM
(sing-song)
Oh my precious Sadie, how I love
you so!
(with a goofy grin)
We're gonna get married.

His CarPlay dings -- a text from **SADIE**.

SADIE (TEXT)
Did you get the reservation? I'm
going to be a little late.

LIAM
(to system)
I did, and I'll be there soon. See
you later!

As he presses send, he focuses on the road. His confident smile grows a little.

INT. RESTAURANT - NIGHT

In a VERY NICE restaurant, Liam, now in date attire, sits in his seat. He's a little ball of energy as he waits for someone. There's a present on the table.

SUPER TITLE: "IV. "PLEASE DON'T GO, SADIE WILCOX"

The door opens. He quickly looks over and gives a big goofy grin at SADIE WILCOX. As she approaches, he stands up.

What a gentleman! They sit down.

LIAM
(nodding)
Madam.

SADIE
(chuckles, nods back)
Gentle sir.

LIAM
You won't believe the day I had.

SADIE
I heard about the tournament.
Congrats.

LIAM
A-thank-ya.

Sadie takes a deep breath. Her expression drops.

SADIE
So, Liam -

LIAM
(looking up from the menu)
Ready to order? I'm starving.

SADIE
Oh. Sure.

A WAITER walks by.

WAITER
What can I get started for you?

LIAM
I'll get the chicken tenders, and
she'll have the same.

He laughs and looks at her. She forces a smile.

SADIE
He's kidding. I'll just do the
Caesar salad.

She drops the smile.

LIAM
(notices)
I'll get the sirloin. Mid-rare,
please. Thanks.

The two sit in silence for a beat.

LIAM
You good?

SADIE

Yeah, I just... look, this is hard
to say, but -

Liam's confident smile instantly vanishes. All he hears is a death sentence. He tries closing his eyes to get away from it. Her mouth moves, but the words are a blur.

He quickly puts his hands on the table.

LIAM

(a desperate whisper)
Wait.

The lights of the restaurant DIM until all other patrons are just frozen silhouettes in the dark. A single, warm SPOTLIGHT envelops their table.

The opening, heartfelt chords of "**PLEASE DON'T GO**" begin.

LIAM (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: PLEADING FOR ONE MORE CHANCE

He pushes his chair back as he sings and moves toward her. She doesn't know how to respond.

SADIE (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: EXPRESSING HER DOUBTS.

He moves through the restaurant.

LIAM (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: PROFESSING LOVE, PROMISING CHANGE

She rises.

SADIE (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: QUESTIONING THIS, BUT ALSO HOPEFUL

He approaches her.

LIAM (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: CONFIDENTLY RESPONDING TO HER

He grabs her hands, and the two begin moving synchronously.

LIAM & SADIE (SINGING)

TBD LYRICS: A POWERFUL DUET ABOUT WANTING TO
PUSH TOGETHER

LIAM (SINGING)

PLEASE DON'T GO

SADIE (SINGING)
I WON'T GO, IF YOU JUST TELL ME SO...

Sadie looks down.

SADIE (SINGING) (CONT'D)
TBD LYRICS: BUT WHAT IF IT DOESN'T WORK?

Liam reassures her.

LIAM (SINGING)
TBD LYRICS: WE CAN MAKE IT WORK, I WILL TRY.

LIAM & SADIE (SINGING)
TBD LYRICS: THE CONCLUSION, THEIR VOICES SOAR

The song reaches its crescendo. They hold each other close.
He leans in to kiss her...

...as the world returns to normal.

His face morphs from a kiss to a weird blank expression.

Sadie stares with bewilderment.

SADIE
(forceful)
Liam!

He breaks out of it.

LIAM
(startled)
What?

Liam looks around the building. He sighs.

LIAM
Please don't go.

SADIE
I have to! Weren't you listening?

Liam plops his head on the table. Sadie rolls her eyes.

LIAM
(into table, petulant)
Whyyyyy?

He gently bonks his head on the table repeatedly.

SADIE
Stop that.

Liam lifts his head up, revealing his red eyes.

LIAM
(whiny)
Please! How can I get to to stay?

SADIE
You can't!

Liam puts his head back down.

LIAM
(into table)
Why not?

SADIE
Stop asking me that! My boss is
already on my case, and I'm going
for that promotion so I can't skip
to go to a dance.

A glimmer of hope. Liam's head jolts up.

LIAM
Wait -- it's a work thing?

SADIE
Yeah, it's right before the formal.
I'll be too tired to go.

LIAM
(blankly)
You can't go to the formal.

SADIE
(nodding)
Uh, yeah. Were you not listening?

LIAM
You're not breaking up with me?

She smacks his hand.

SADIE
What?!

LIAM
I thought you were breaking up with
me. We just sang about it.

A soft PIANO CHORD from "Please Don't Go" plays only for us.
Sadie just stares, bewildered.

SADIE
Sang?
(rattling Liam's glass)
How strong is this?

Liam gets up. A triumphant:

LIAM
Woohoo!

Sadie shields her face with her hand.

SADIE
(whispering)
Sit down!

Liam gets down.

LIAM
I love you so much.

Sadie shakes her head. A confused laugh.

SADIE
I love you too.

EXT. RESTAURANT - NIGHT

Liam walks Sadie to her car.

SADIE
For the record, my song would've
had a sick guitar solo.

She breaks into air guitar. It's cool. Not awkward at all.

LIAM
(chuckles)
Next time.

They share a real, non-fantastical kiss. It's sweet and simple. She gets in her car and drives off.

He walks into the night.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. CAMPUS - NIGHT

SUPER TITLE: "V. GOOD NIGHT, LIAM HAYMORE"

Liam walks through the empty campus at night. He's content. He pulls out his AirPods and puts them in.

He walks past the lecture hall and notices a GRADE SHEET on the door. He scans it, suspensefully pausing his music.

LIAM H.: A-

A slow, genuine smile spreads across his face. He did it.

He resumes his music. As he walks to wherever it is that he's going, the quiet, hopeful instrumental from his AirPods SWELLS as we...

CUT TO BLACK.

THE END